Transportation:

Protein is a major component in transportation of certain molecules. For example, haemoglobin is a protein that transports oxygen throughout the body.

Storage:

Proteins are used to store certain molecules. Ferritin is a protein which stores iron in the liver.

Antibodies:

All antibodies are proteins. Antibodies neutralize infection, illness and diseases.

2.3 Lipids

2.3.1 Definition

Chemically, Lipids can be defined as esters of fatty acids with alcohol. They are insoluble in water and soluble in organic solvents such as alcohol, ether, benzene and chloroform.

2.3.2 Classification

Based on the chemical nature, lipids are classified as

Simple lipids

These are esters of fatty acids with glycerol or long chain alcohols. They are further classified as follows.

(a) Fats: Fats are glyceric esters of fatty acids. Lipids in animals are called as fats while the lipids in plants are called as oils. Example: Triacylglycerol.

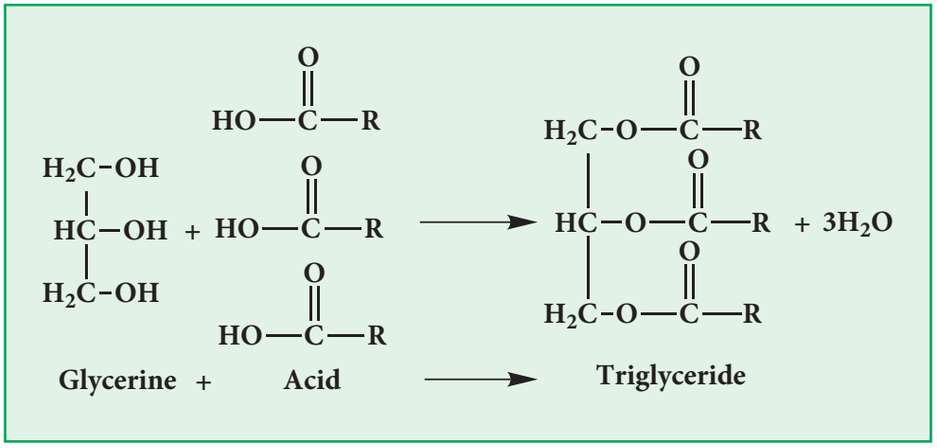

Figure 2.8 Formation of triacylglyceride